



Saying Goodbye to
Otis



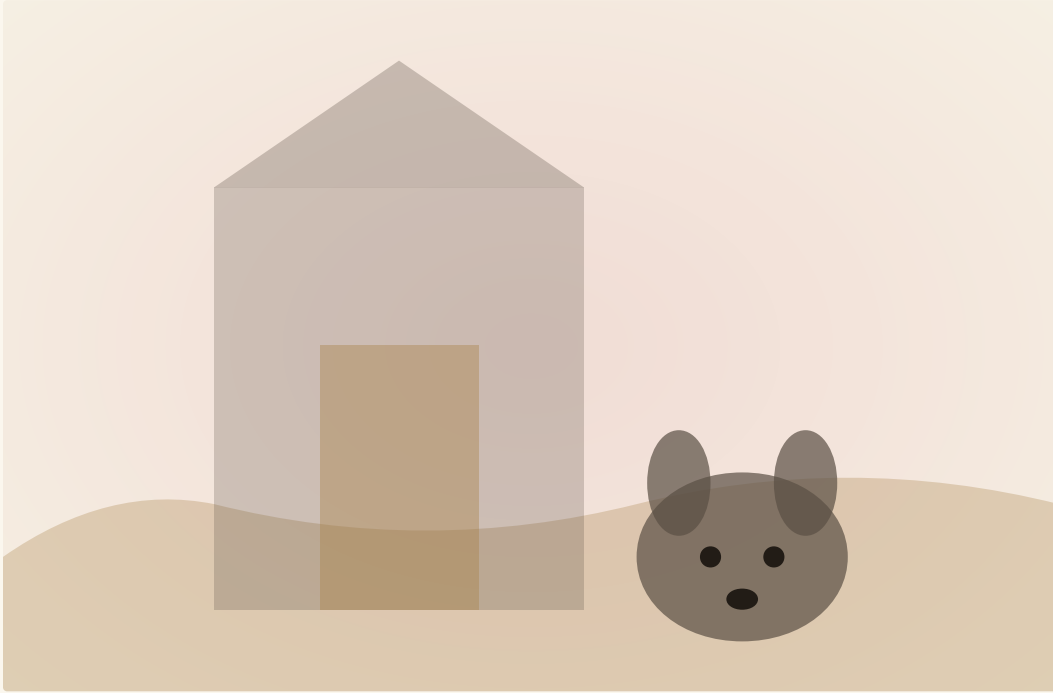
A story for **Emma**

2014 — 2026



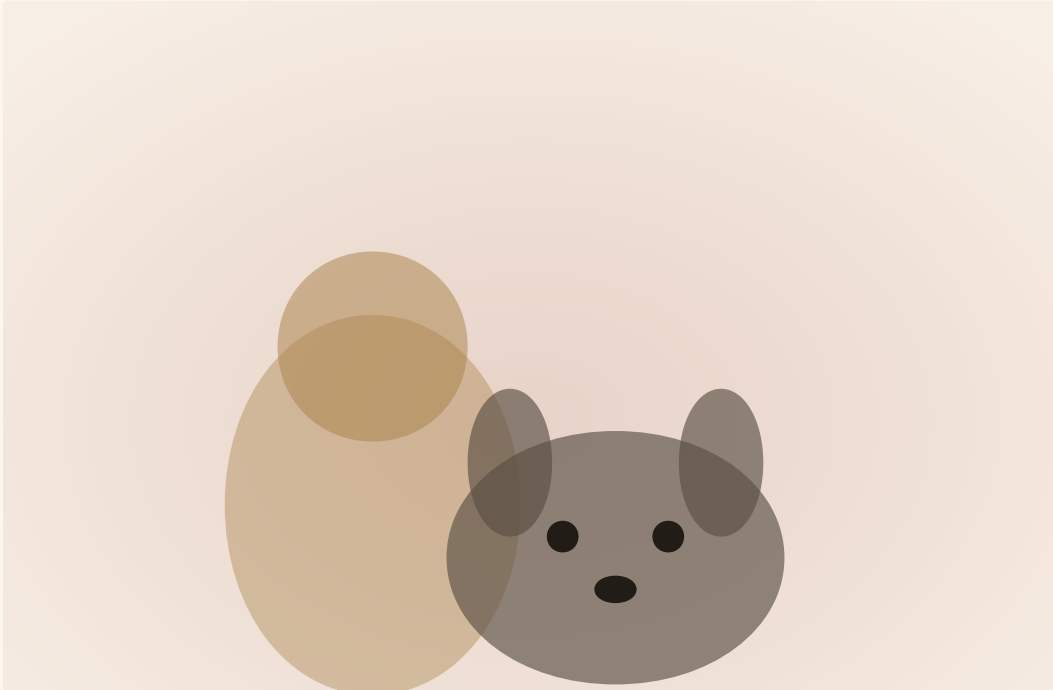
For *Emma*,
and for *Otis*,
who loved her so very much.

2014 — 2026



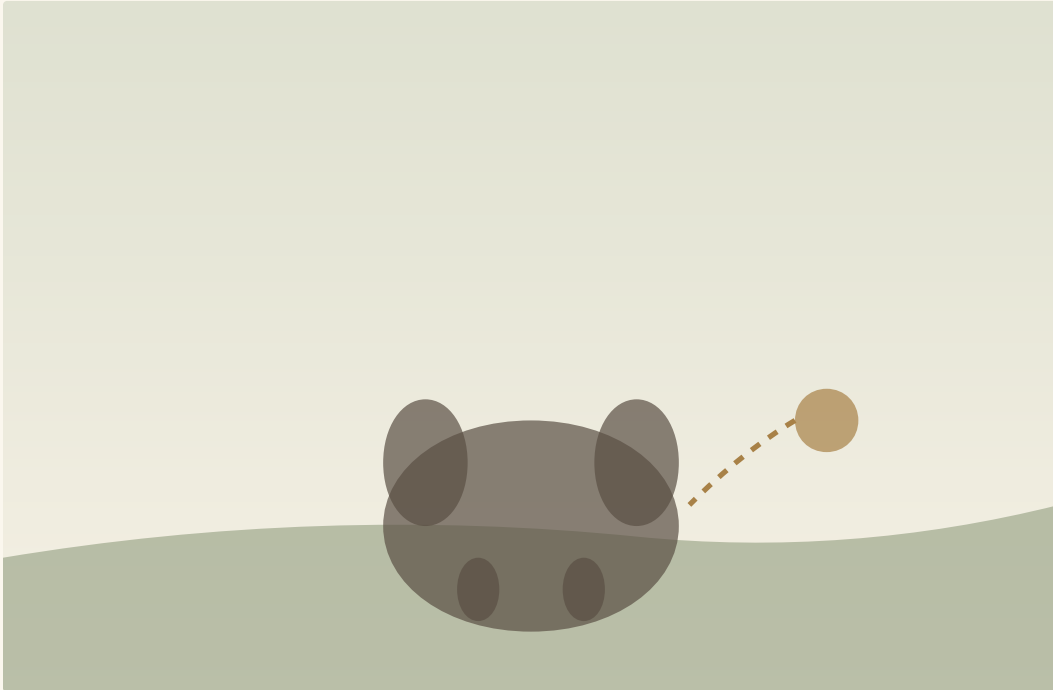
Once, in a home full of love,
there lived a dog named *Otis*.

Otis was a sweet rescue mutt, possibly part
beagle, with floppy ears and the softest brown
eyes — eyes that always knew when you
needed a friend.



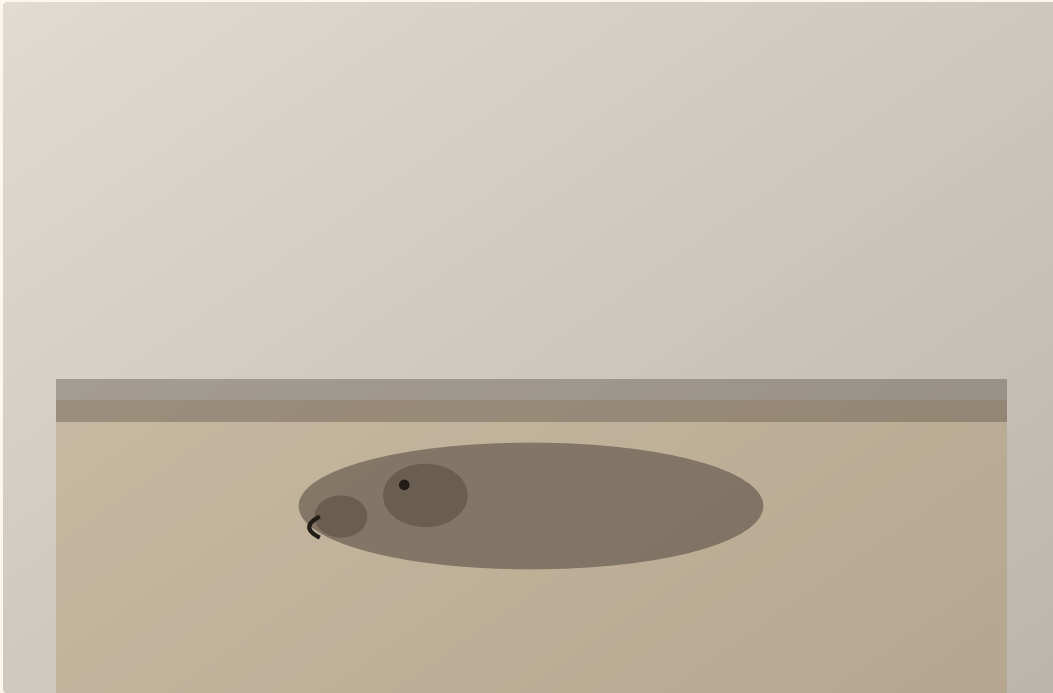
Otis loved *Emma* more than anything in the
whole world.

And Emma loved Otis right back.



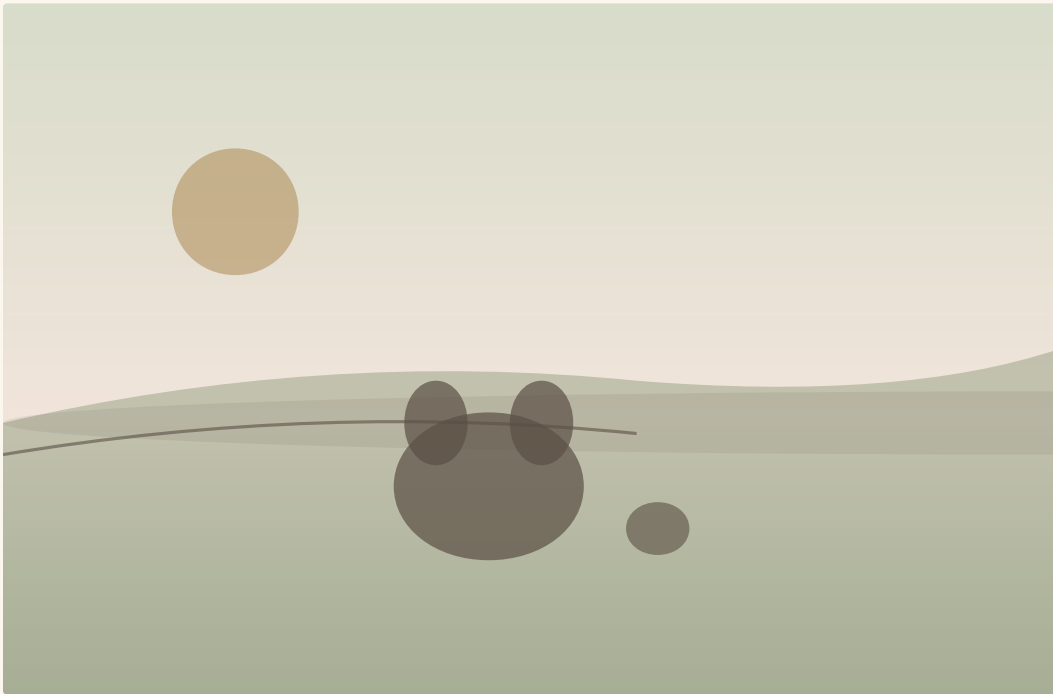
Every day was an adventure together.

Otis's favorite thing in the world was *chasing*
tennis balls in the backyard.



And when the day was done, he would curl up
at the foot of Emma's bed, where it was warm
and safe.

That was Otis's favorite place to dream.



There was one day Emma will always remember.

*The day Otis followed her to the lake, and they both
came home soaking wet, laughing the whole way.*

That was the kind of love Otis and Emma shared.



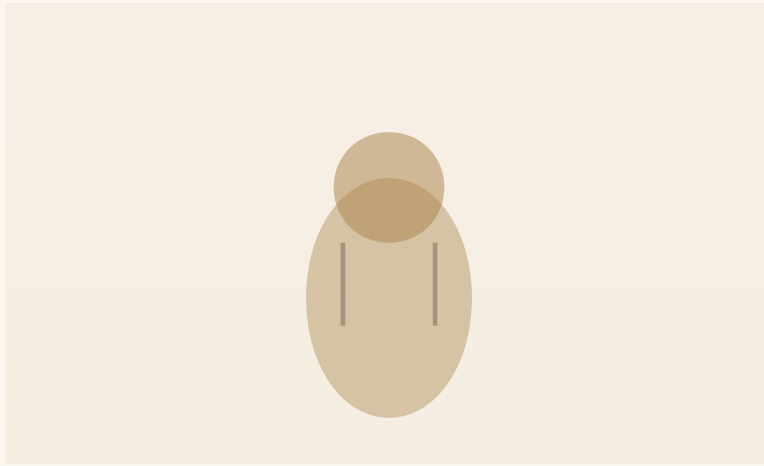
But every living thing has a beginning, a middle,
and an end.

Even the ones we love most.

Otis's body got tired.

And then, very gently,
his body stopped working.

That is what "died" means.



This might make Emma feel a lot of things.

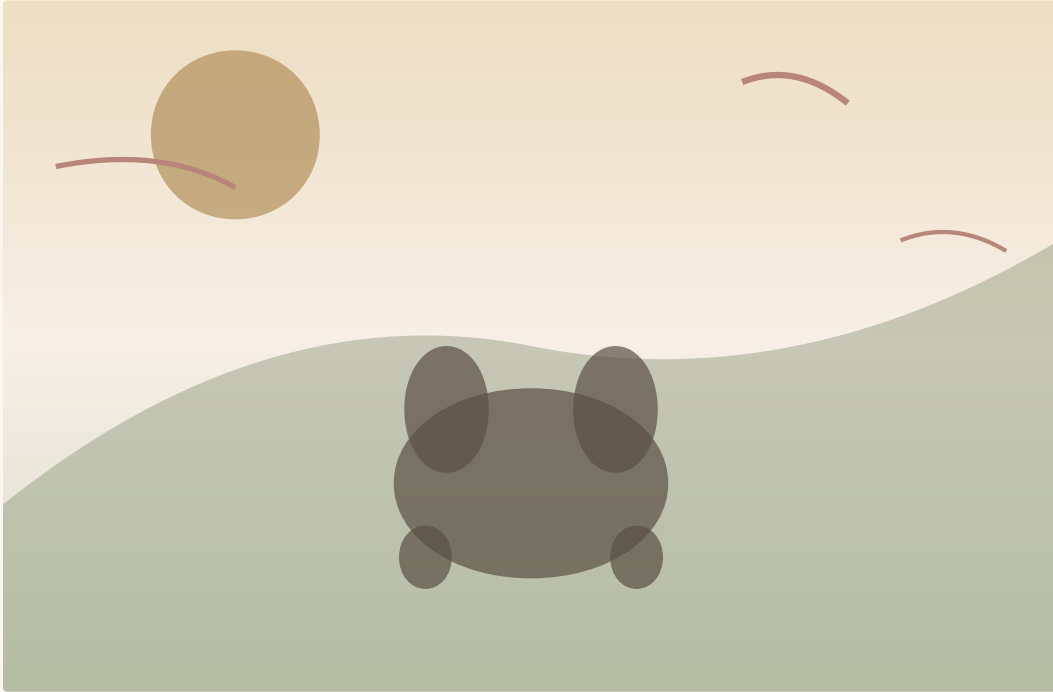
Sad. Maybe angry.

Maybe like nothing feels right anymore.

Maybe like crying. Maybe like not crying at all.

All of these feelings are okay.

They mean Emma loved Otis very, very much.



Some people say there is a place called *the Rainbow Bridge*.

A sunny meadow where pets run free,
where bodies don't get tired anymore.

Where Otis can *chase tennis balls*
for as long as he wants.

Here is the most important thing of all.

*The love between Emma and
Otis did not stop when Otis
died.*

Love does not work that way.

*It stays.
It always stays.*

When Emma misses Otis — and that will happen
many times — there are things Emma can do.

Look at a picture and remember.

Tell a story to someone who will listen.

Say Otis's name out loud — names are meant to be said.



Otis was a good boy.
Otis was *Emma's* dog.

And Otis will always,
always be loved.

– end –

A place to write a memory of Otis

Fill in by hand whenever it feels right.

The day Otis came home:

Otis's favorite sound:

The funniest thing Otis ever did:

One thing Otis taught me:

What I want to remember most:
